10 AIRLINES. UK + INDIA. MAR TO AUG 2026 VS 2025.

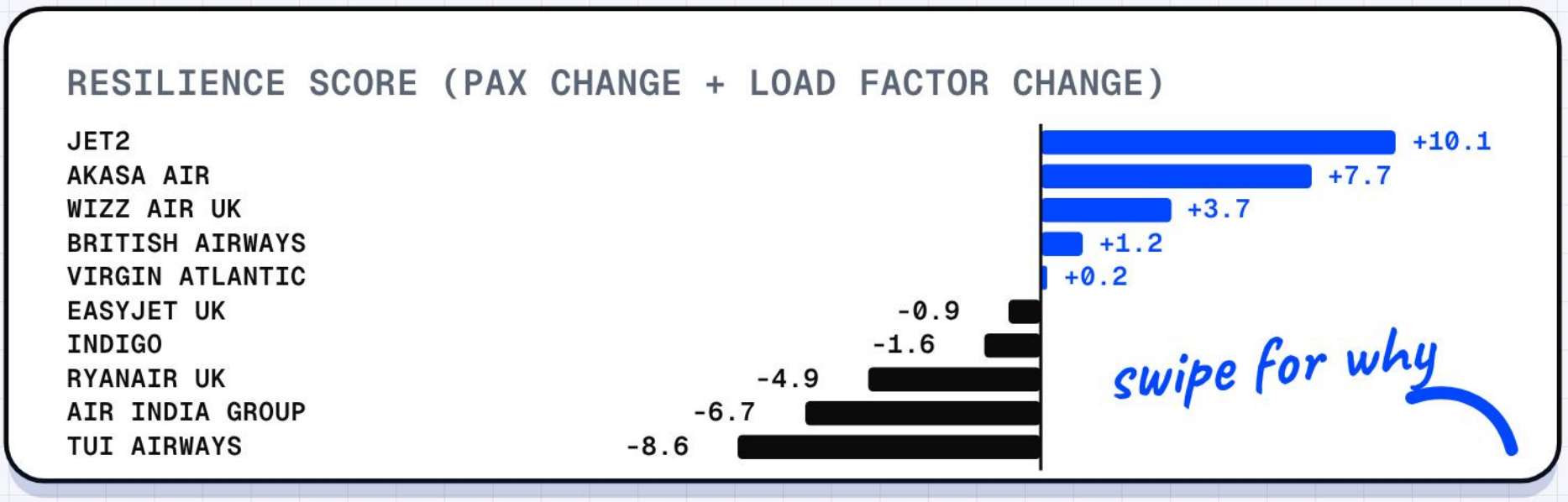
Cut seats or add seats?

Jet2 +8.9% pax

Air India Group -7.2% pax

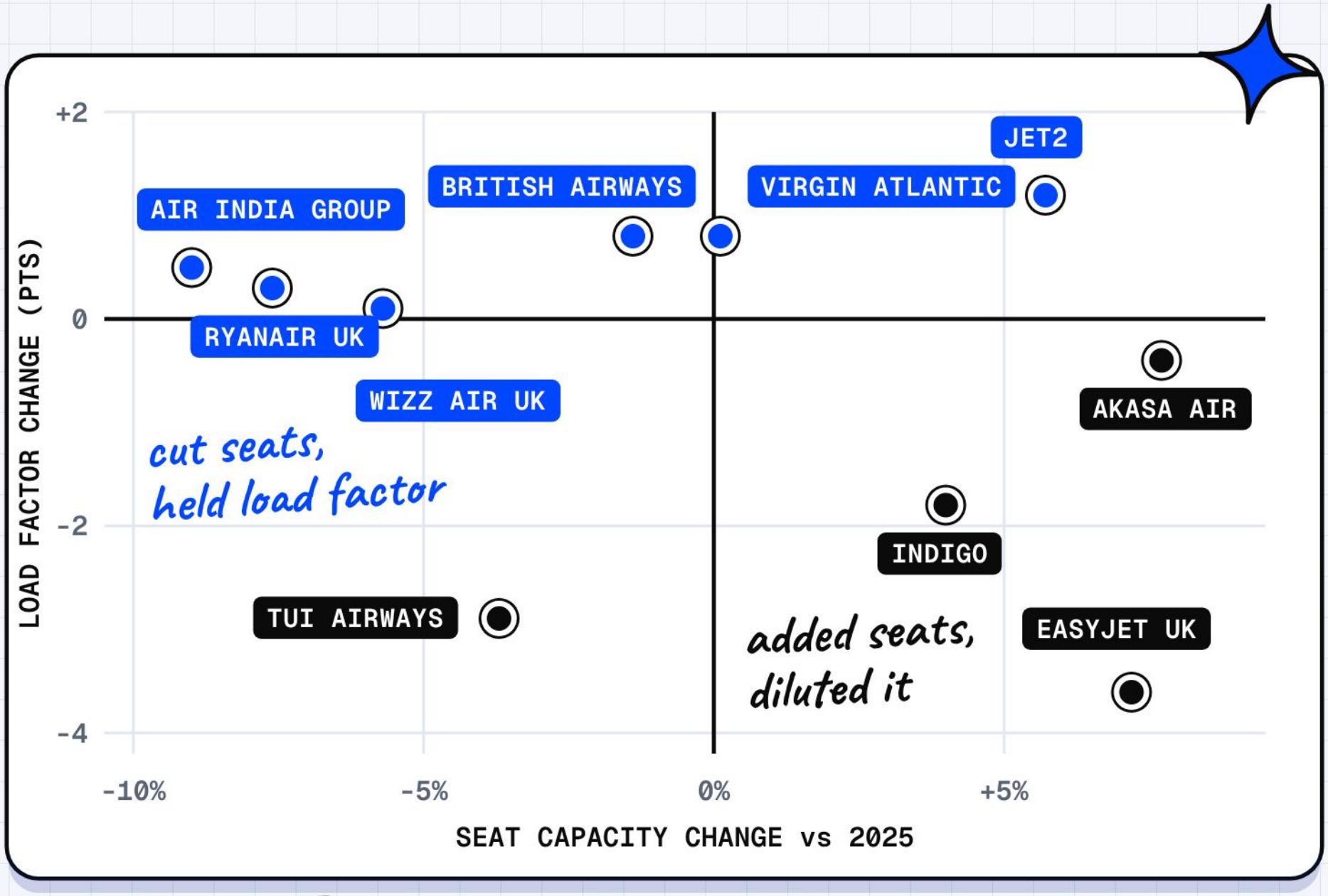
easyJet UK -3.6 pts LF

I compared how 10 airlines handled the 2026 shock. Half cut capacity. Half added it. The results split hard.



VARESH NIRBHAVNE

Cutting seats **protected** load factor. **It cost passengers.**



Air India Group

-9.0% SEATS

+0.5 LOAD FACTOR PTS

-7.2% PASSENGERS

Load factor is a **guardrail**, not the goal.

Cut only where volume is cheap to lose

Ryanair UK and Air India held load factor but lost 5 to 7% of passengers.

Add only where demand is proven

Jet2 grew seats 5.7% and filled them. easyJet UK added 7.2% and lost 3.6 pts.

THE HONEST BIT

Descriptive, not causal. No fare data, so no profit view. UK CAA and India DGCA define load factor slightly differently. SpiceJet left out (no 2025 data).

Built in Power BI, SQL, Python.

github.com/iguesshecodes/airline-shock-2026